

DANIAL SALMAN

Owen Graduate School of Management, 401 21st Avenue South, Nashville, TN 37203

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ACADEMIC POSITIONS

Postdoctoral Scholar in Finance

2026–present

Owen Graduate School of Management, Vanderbilt University

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Finance

2026

Foster School of Business, University of Washington

M.A. and B.A. in Economics

2016

Boston University

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Household Finance, Labor Economics, Innovation, Venture Capital

WORKING PAPERS

End of the Road? Autonomous Vehicles and Displacement Risk [\[SSRN\]](#)

New technologies have renewed concerns about job displacement. In this paper, I link workers' subjective displacement expectations to their direct and social exposure to a disruptive technology: autonomous vehicles (AVs). I find that commercial driver licensing and employment in truck driving fall disproportionately in more AV-exposed areas. The remaining drivers extend their work hours and reduce participation in mortgage markets relative to less-exposed, neighboring drivers. Changes in household spending on alcohol and tobacco products are consistent with heightened automation-induced anxiety. The results indicate that perceived displacement risk affects households' labor supply, credit behavior, and health, all of which could inform welfare assessments and policy responses to automation.

Presentations: NBER Digital Economics and Artificial Intelligence (scheduled), NBER Economics of Transportation 2026, American Economic Association 2026, Colorado Finance Summit 2025, ABFR Doctoral Research Symposium 2025, Wharton Innovation Doctoral Symposium 2025

Relief Beliefs: Effects of Anticipated Student Loan Forgiveness (with Xuan Xie) [\[SSRN\]](#)

Political support for student loan forgiveness has been growing, particularly on the left, but evidence regarding its effects remains limited. We evaluate the immediate consumption response to President Biden's 2022 loan forgiveness announcement which promised debt relief of \$10,000 to \$20,000 for approximately 42 million borrowers. We find that retail stores located in counties with a 1 percentage point higher share of eligible student loan borrowers saw a persistent 0.1% increase in weekly sales. The positive spending response was absent in counties with high shares of financially delinquent households, consistent with delinquent borrowers being liquidity constrained and unable to smooth consumption. Novel data on debt relief eligibility and applications suggest that student loan borrowers anticipated relief they ultimately did not receive and adjusted their spending in response.

Presentations: NBER Economics of Education 2026, SAFE Household Finance Workshop, American Finance Association 2026 (poster), Southern Finance Association 2025, Financial Management Association 2025

WORK IN PROGRESS

Who Benefits from Venture Capital? (with Victor Lyonnet and Léa Stern)

PUBLICATIONS

Pre-doctoral:

Institutional and Political Determinants of Statutory Tax Rates: Empirical Evidence from Sub-Saharan Africa (with Sanjeev Gupta, Carlos Mulas-Granados, Jianhong Liu and Kelsey Ross)
Journal of African Development, 2021 [[Article](#)]

The Future of Central America: Challenges for Sustainable Development
Inter-American Development Bank, 2019 [[Book](#)]

INVITED CONFERENCES, SEMINARS, AND WORKSHOPS

- 2026:** NBER Digital Economics and Artificial Intelligence (scheduled), NBER Economics of Transportation, NBER Economics of Education, SAFE Household Finance Workshop, American Economic Association, American Finance Association[‡], Junior Academics Research Seminars in Finance, University of Texas at Dallas
- 2025:** Colorado Finance Summit, ABFR Doctoral Research Symposium, Coast-to-Coast Doctoral Workshop, Southern Finance Association*, Financial Management Association, Society of Labor Economists, Wharton Innovation Doctoral Symposium, Inter-Finance PhD Seminar*, NBER Entrepreneurship Research Boot Camp
- 2024:** Western Economic Association International, Financial Management Association[†]
- 2023:** Wharton Summer School on Structural Estimation in Corporate Finance, Finance Theory Group Summer School

* denotes presentations by co-authors, [†] denotes discussions, and [‡] denotes posters.

AWARDS

Edna Benson Fellowship	2023
Foster PhD Program Fellowship	2022
George and Pearl Corkery Scholarship	2019
Student Research Award	2016
Presidential Scholarship	2013–2016

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of Washington 2019–2026
Teaching Assistant

- Corporate Finance (Undergraduate, Full-time MBA, Hybrid MBA)
- Advanced Corporate Finance (Full-time MBA)
- International Finance (Full-time MBA, Executive MBA)
- Game Theory (Full-time MBA)
- Introductory Macroeconomics (Undergraduate)
- Introductory Microeconomics (Undergraduate)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of Washington <i>Research Associate</i>	2021–2026
Center for Global Development <i>Research Assistant</i>	2017–2019
Inter-American Development Bank <i>Consultant</i>	2017
Boston University <i>Research Assistant</i>	2016
United Nations Secretariat <i>Intern</i>	2016

REFERENCES

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MISCELLANEOUS

Citizenship	United States
Data	Special Sworn Status (Census Bureau)
Languages	English, French, Urdu/Hindi, Spanish
Volunteer	Court Appointed Special Advocate (CASA)